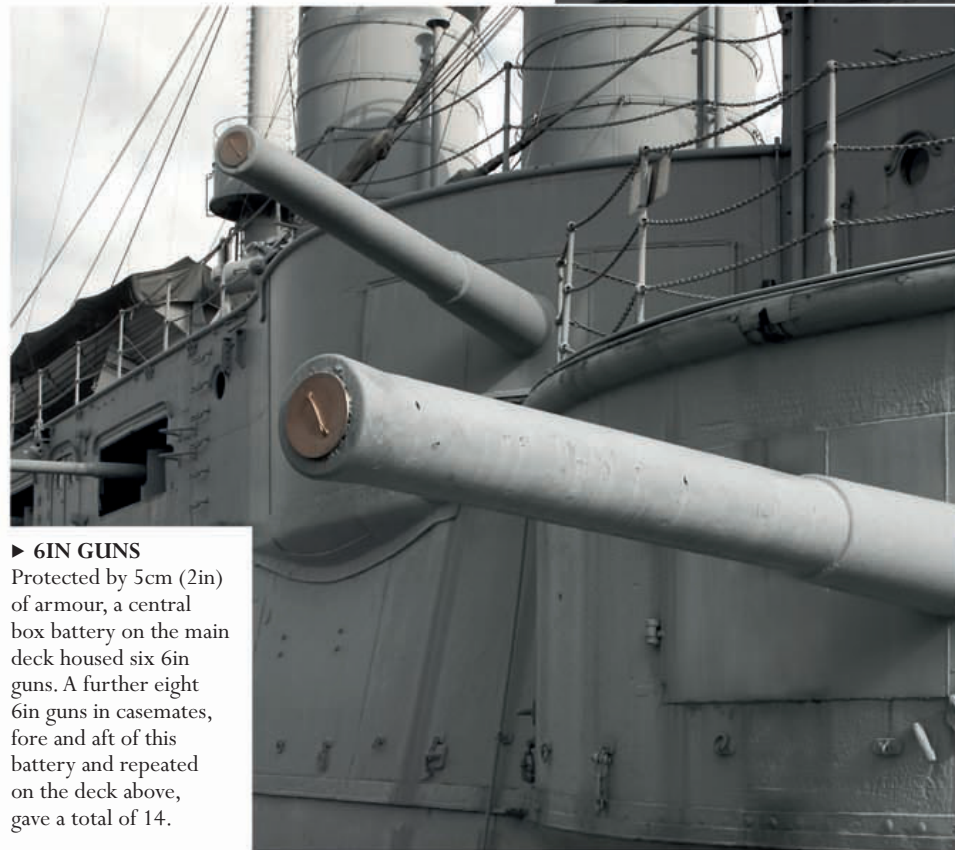
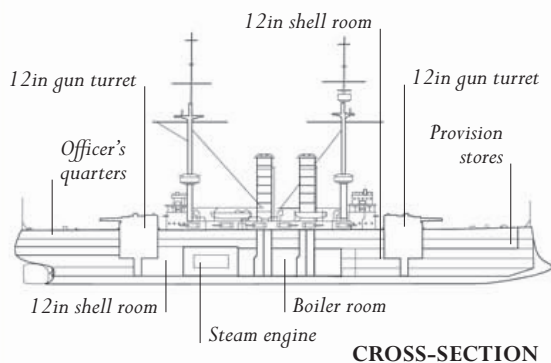


ARMAMENTS AND QUARTERS

To supplement its main armament, the *Mikasa* mounted a variety of smaller-calibre guns, from 6in ones for use against cruisers and destroyers, to 12, 3, and 1 pounders. There were also rifle-calibre machine guns. Living conditions were almost unchanged from the days of sail, with the men sleeping in hammocks and eating at fold-up tables.



► 6IN GUNS

Protected by 5cm (2in) of armour, a central box battery on the main deck housed six 6in guns. A further eight 6in guns in casemates, fore and aft of this battery and repeated on the deck above, gave a total of 14.

► RANGEFINDER

The *Mikasa*'s Barr & Stroud rangefinders were far superior to the types used by the Russian ships at Tsushima. They were decisive in the battle, giving the Japanese fleet long-range firepower superiority.



▲ 3IN GUN CASEMATE

Above the central 6in box battery were eight 3in quick-firing guns on pedestal mounts, with only light splinter-shields for protection.

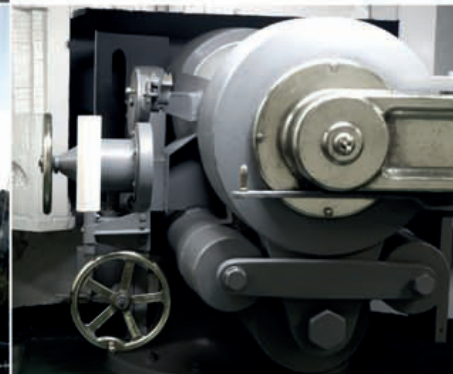
◀ PORT TO 3IN BATTERY

It was through this port that the Russian second-in-command, Rear-Admiral Nikolai Nebogatov, boarded the *Mikasa* to surrender at Tsushima.



▲ HOTCHKISS 3-POUNDER GUN

These lightweight guns were mounted on simple pedestals, allowing the gunners to follow fast-moving targets such as torpedo-boats.



◀ 6IN GUN BREECH

The 6in guns were "quick-firers", their ammunition comprising both projectile and charge in a brass cartridge. They could fire up to six rounds per minute.